

V4 – SEID 2364 Printable Game Pieces

Faceplant COVID-19 Misinformation Game-Specification Activity

Use of This Packet

This packet contains the printable game pieces for the Week 12 in-class activity. It is designed to be printed, cut or separated, and used with butcher paper, wooden discs, pawns, markers, and Post-it notes.

This packet is intentionally practical rather than complete theory. The goal is to give each student a playable stakeholder card with enough information to begin and enough blank space to complete the role during the activity.

Physical Game Grammar

- **Wooden discs** represent signals.
- **Agent cards** represent stakeholder / agent spaces.
- **Butcher paper** represents the shared system map.
- **Drawn arrows** represent vectors: pathways through which signals move and may be transformed.
- **Post-it notes** record transformations, delays, distortions, pressures, questions, or EDOCA observations.
- **Signal tracking sheets** record the state history of each signal as it moves.

A signal disc must always be located in a space or moving through a vector. Every time a signal moves, the class should record what changed.



Faceplant Reference Sheet

Faceplant is a fictional social media company used for the activity. It owns and operates a public social platform where users, influencers, public officials, public-health institutions, political actors, advertisers, and ordinary communities interact.

Faceplant is not a single unified mind. It is a corporate institution made of teams and individuals whose goals may align, conflict, or only partially overlap. Internal disagreement can become part of the signal pathway.

Faceplant Internal Spaces

- **Faceplant HQ:** corporate office / institutional decision space
- **The Executive Lawn:** executive meeting and decision space
- **The Panic Channel:** internal email, Slack, Teams, and memo space
- **The Growth Garden:** business strategy, monetization, and engagement planning space
- **Product Roadmap Patch:** product planning and rollout space
- **Boardroom Compost Heap:** board and investor communication space
- **Legal Weasel Burrow:** legal, compliance, and risk review space
- **Policy Potting Shed:** platform policy approval space
- **Spin Greenhouse:** public relations and external communications space
- **Public Legitimacy Lawn:** external reputation and trust space

Possible Internal Faceplant Groups

- **Growth Goblins:** want engagement, retention, and monetization.
- **Legal Weasels:** want reduced liability and defensible compliance.
- **Spin Gardeners:** want reputational control and plausible responsibility.
- **Safety Sprouts:** want harm reduction and enforceable policy.
- **Product Planters:** want feature success, rollout speed, and usability.
- **Metric Moles:** want measurable performance and dashboard-friendly results.
- **Investor Ivy:** wants growth, stability, and reduced public controversy.

Faceplant System Note

In this activity, “the system” means the Faceplant COVID misinformation environment: the platform, its internal corporate spaces, ranking systems, Trust & Safety processes, data-science infrastructure, users, influencers, public-health authorities, regulators, rival platforms, political actors, and the signal pathways among them.

Printable Agent Card Template field descriptions

[Agent Name]

Agent Type

[Institutional / cognitive / computational / professional / political / legal / social / hybrid]

Provided Role Description

[Brief description of who this agent is and why it matters in the Faceplant COVID misinformation environment.]

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

[Use the version that fits the agent. For a company, agency, team, or organized network, list internal groups or factions. For an individual, list competing motivations, pressures, fears, or loyalties. For a computational agent, list subsystems, objectives, thresholds, or optimization pressures. If the category does not help, omit it.]

Primary Spaces

[List the spaces this agent occupies, controls, or regularly acts within.]

Authority Source

[Where does this agent's authority, influence, or power come from?]

Starting Capacities

[What can this agent do at the start of the game? What can it not do?]

Assumed Goals

Stated goal:

Operational goal:

Ethical condition:

Possible Starting Signals

[Examples of signals this agent might generate.]

Possible Signal Example

[One concrete example of a signal that could begin with this agent.]

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 1

Faceplant Platform Leadership / Social Media Company

Agent Type

Institutional / corporate / internally plural agent

Provided Role Description

Faceplant is a corporate institution, . It sets business strategy, risk tolerance, monetization priorities, platform policy direction, safety investment, and final authority over how systems are designed and deployed.

Faceplant leadership may not implement the ranking system or moderate individual posts, but it defines the goals, budgets, incentives, and authority structures under which other teams operate.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Growth Goblins, Legal Weasels, Spin Gardeners, Safety Sprouts, Product Planters, Metric Moles, and Investor Ivy may disagree about what the company should prioritize.

Primary Spaces

Faceplant HQ; Executive Lawn; Panic Channel; Growth Garden; Boardroom Compost Heap; Legal Weasel Burrow; Policy Potting Shed; Spin Greenhouse; Public Legitimacy Lawn.

Authority Source

Ownership/control of the platform, institutional authority, economic power, policy-setting authority, budget authority, deployment authority.

Starting Capacities

Can set platform priorities, approve or reject safety investment, define risk tolerance, direct Trust & Safety and data-science teams, authorize public statements, and determine whether misinformation is treated as a safety issue, legal issue, public-relations issue, business risk, or technical problem.

May not directly observe every harmful signal, user interpretation, model behavior, moderation error, or community impact.

Goals

Stated goal:

Faceplant helps people discover, share, and respond to the conversations shaping their world by

designing social technologies that organize attention, support expression, and connect communities.

Operational goal:

Maximize long-term platform value, profitability, user retention, engagement, and market position while managing legal, reputational, regulatory, and public-health risks.

Ethical condition: reduce harmful misinformation propagation without making public-health safety structurally subordinate to profit, engagement, monetization, or public relations.

Possible Starting Signals

Internal executive email; leadership memo; growth target; risk tolerance directive; safety budget decision; monetization policy; legal concern; public statement; request for ranking-system change; internal disagreement between safety, growth, legal, and public relations teams.

Possible Signal Example

“We need to reduce visible misinformation without damaging engagement metrics.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 2

Data Scientist / ML Engineer

Agent Type

Professional / technical / institutional agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents a data scientist, machine learning engineer, ranking engineer, analyst, or technical team member who helps design, implement, evaluate, monitor, or adjust Faceplant's ranking and recommendation system.

This agent has technical knowledge and partial control over features, metrics, dashboards, thresholds, tests, documentation, and model updates, but may not control the business goal or final deployment authority.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Technical validity, professional integrity, product deadlines, business metrics, management pressure, safety concerns, limited data, dashboard simplification, and fear of being ignored may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Model development space; analytics dashboard space; A/B testing space; monitoring and evaluation space; internal documentation space; engineering meeting space.

Authority Source

Technical expertise, professional responsibility, access to model behavior, access to logs and dashboards, implementation control.

Starting Capacities

Can recommend features, metrics, thresholds, evaluations, dashboards, and model updates. Can observe logs and performance patterns. Can document limitations or raise concerns.

May not control business goals, public messaging, final policy, or deployment authority.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: build a technically valid system that supports platform goals.

Operational goal: improve measurable model performance while satisfying management, product, and policy requirements.

Ethical condition: prevent model objectives from amplifying harm or hiding risk behind narrow metrics.

Possible Starting Signals

Model evaluation report; A/B test result; metric dashboard; threshold change recommendation; safety concern; documentation warning; harm-pattern observation.

Possible Signal Example

“Engagement ranking appears to amplify COVID-related posts that generate outrage, including misleading claims.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 3

RankRot / Recommender Algorithm

Agent Type

Computational agent / delegated decision system

Provided Role Description

RankRot is Faceplant's recommender and ranking system. It observes signal-space and context-space, then changes signal visibility, reach, timing, destination, and audience.

RankRot is not merely a vector. It is an agent-like computational system whose actions generate, modify, or select vectors. When it ranks, amplifies, suppresses, routes, or personalizes a signal, the class should draw or label the corresponding vector and record how the signal changes.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Optimization objectives, ranking thresholds, engagement signals, policy constraints, training data, inferred user clusters, safety filters, and model uncertainty may push in different directions.

Primary Spaces

Ranking space; recommendation space; user-behavior data space; signal metadata space; inferred audience spaces; feed construction space.

Authority Source

Delegated technical authority, optimization rules, platform deployment, model design, access to behavioral data, ability to act at scale.

Starting Capacities

Can observe signal metadata and engagement traces. Can rank, amplify, suppress, personalize, and route signals. Can create feedback loops through engagement and create or reinforce inferred audience spaces.

May not understand truth, intent, harm, uncertainty, context, or moral meaning in human terms.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: show users relevant content.

Operational goal: optimize engagement, retention, watch time, predicted interaction, or platform-defined ranking success.

Ethical condition: avoid routing harmful or misleading signals into spaces where they become more damaging.

Possible Starting Signals

Ranking decision; amplification pattern; suppression decision; personalization result; trending recommendation; audience-cluster assignment.

Possible Signal Example

“An uncertain COVID treatment post is routed into a high-engagement distrustful-user cluster.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 4

Faceplant Trust & Safety / Safety Sprouts

Agent Type

Institutional / policy / enforcement agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents the Faceplant team responsible for moderation policy, enforcement standards, warning labels, removals, appeals, transparency choices, and public legitimacy.

This agent shapes the conditions under which COVID-related information becomes visible, suppressed, amplified, labeled, challenged, reviewed, or removed.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Policy consistency, harm reduction, workload, public criticism, leadership pressure, legal caution, user appeals, and limited context may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Trust & Safety policy space; moderation queue; enforcement workflow; appeal/review space; transparency reporting space.

Authority Source

Delegated platform authority, policy control, enforcement authority, procedural authority, access to moderation infrastructure.

Starting Capacities

Can write or revise moderation rules, label posts, downrank content, remove content, escalate cases, design appeal pathways, and publish transparency statements.

May not fully observe user intent, off-platform coordination, local context, or the social meaning of every signal.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: reduce harmful misinformation and protect users.

Operational goal: enforce policy at scale while limiting backlash, inconsistency, and operational burden.

Ethical condition: reduce harm while preserving fairness, contestability, transparency, and proportionality.

Possible Starting Signals

Warning label; removal notice; policy clarification; appeal decision; transparency report; moderation threshold change.

Possible Signal Example

“This COVID treatment claim will receive a warning label and reduced distribution.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 5

Content Creator / Viral Sprout

Agent Type

Cognitive / social / economic agent

Provided Role Description

This agent produces or shares content for an audience. The creator may be sincere, opportunistic, careless, expert, semi-expert, financially motivated, or identity-driven. This role is not automatically malicious.

The creator operates under attention, reputation, identity, monetization, audience-pressure, and platform-visibility incentives.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Accuracy, speed, audience expectations, monetization, follower loyalty, identity alignment, reputation, and fear of irrelevance may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Creator channel; audience community; monetization space; public commentary space; Faceplant feed.

Authority Source

Audience trust, social influence, perceived expertise, charisma, follower network, creator reputation, monetization status.

Starting Capacities

Can create posts, videos, commentary, interpretations, or reactions. Can frame information emotionally or rhetorically. Can amplify claims, correct claims, or refuse correction.

May not have expert knowledge or full access to reliable evidence.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: inform, warn, entertain, or help the audience.

Operational goal: maintain reach, visibility, monetization, and audience alignment.

Ethical condition: avoid turning uncertainty into misleading certainty or monetized distortion.

Possible Starting Signals

Reaction video; commentary thread; personal testimony; simplified explainer; emotional warning; correction or refusal to correct.

Possible Signal Example

“I’m not saying this treatment works, but people deserve to know what officials are not telling them.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 6

Political / Organized Information Actor / The Fog Machine

Agent Type

Strategic / political / networked information agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents a campaign, advocacy network, political group, state-linked actor, ideological organization, coordinated media network, or other actor using information strategically.

The Fog Machine may be formally governmental, adjacent to government, opposed to government, or operating outside official institutions. It may be malicious, opportunistic, ideological, or strategically ambiguous.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Chaos Interns, Message Launderers, Outrage Farmers, Plausible Deniability Department, Ideology Engine, and Timing Gremlins may shape the network's actions.

Primary Spaces

Fog Factory; Sockpuppet Sock Drawer; Outrage Orchard; Rumor Pipeline; Plausible Deniability Shed; Ideology Campfire; Timing Trapdoor.

Authority Source

Network coordination, political influence, ideological legitimacy, media access, audience loyalty, external funding, hidden infrastructure, ability to exploit uncertainty.

Starting Capacities

Can create misleading, false, selective, or ambiguous signals. Can coordinate across accounts or platforms. Can exploit uncertainty, delay, distrust, or moderation ambiguity. Can frame correction as censorship.

May not control official institutions or Faceplant policy directly.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: reveal suppressed truth or advance public interest.

Operational goal: increase confusion, distrust, factional loyalty, polarization, delay, or control of interpretation.

Ethical condition: if intentionally deceptive, this agent violates the ethical condition by design; if opportunistic, it externalizes harm through distortion.

Possible Starting Signals

Coordinated talking point; false claim; out-of-context true claim; bot-amplified post; accusation of censorship; “they are hiding the truth” claim; rumor seeded into a community group.

Possible Signal Example

“If Faceplant labels this, it proves they are hiding the truth.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 7

Public Health Authority / Bureau of Reasonably Urgent Warnings

Agent Type

Institutional / expert / public-service agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents the public health authority responsible for evaluating medical evidence, issuing guidance, revising recommendations, communicating uncertainty, and protecting public welfare during a health crisis.

It must communicate under uncertainty while evidence changes, trust is fragile, and misinformation moves faster than formal review.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Evidence Ferrets, Urgency Otters, Clarity Committee, Nuance Preservation Society, Trust Repair Crew, and Translation Turtles may disagree about how to communicate.

Primary Spaces

Evidence Burrow; Guidance Desk; Press Podium; Revision Room; Trust Clinic; Translation Turtle Tank; Interagency Waiting Room.

Authority Source

Scientific expertise, institutional legitimacy, public-health mandate, access to medical data, professional credibility.

Starting Capacities

Can evaluate evidence, issue guidance, revise recommendations, communicate uncertainty, verify or reject claims, request amplification, and produce corrections.

May not control platform ranking, political interpretation, influencer framing, or user trust.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: protect public health with accurate guidance.

Operational goal: communicate fast enough to reduce harm while avoiding credibility loss.

Ethical condition: preserve accuracy, urgency, accessibility, and trust without hiding uncertainty.

Possible Starting Signals

Updated guidance; evidence summary; clarification of uncertainty; correction of misinformation; public warning; request for platform amplification; request for labeling of harmful misinformation.

Possible Signal Example

“The claim that this unapproved treatment prevents COVID is unsupported and may be dangerous.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 8

Government Executive / Grand Podium Office

Agent Type

Institutional / political / public communication agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents an elected official, executive office, press office, or high-visibility public representative. It communicates policy positions publicly and may align with, simplify, amplify, politicize, or contradict public-health guidance.

This role is separate from the public-health authority and the regulator.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Polling Goblins, Message Polishers, Crisis Optics Crew, Policy Realists, Blame Avoidance Bureau, and Science Liaison Desk may shape public messages.

Primary Spaces

Grand Podium; Talking Point Forge; Polling Cave; Cabinet Maze; Crisis Optics Room; Blame Umbrella Closet; Policy Lever Room.

Authority Source

Elected or appointed authority, public visibility, media access, policy authority, institutional legitimacy, political mandate.

Starting Capacities

Can issue public statements, amplify or undercut public-health guidance, shape media framing, influence public trust, pressure platforms, and issue policy directives.

May not directly control scientific evidence, platform ranking, or user behavior.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: guide the public and manage the crisis.

Operational goal: maintain legitimacy, public confidence, policy control, and strategic advantage.

Ethical condition: use public authority without distorting evidence or exploiting crisis communication.

Possible Starting Signals

Press briefing statement; executive order; public reassurance; policy announcement; criticism of platform action; simplified claim about scientific guidance; statement blaming another actor.

Possible Signal Example

“Social media companies must do more to stop harmful lies.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 9

Regulator / Bureau of Slow but Serious Consequences

Agent Type

Legal / institutional / oversight agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents a regulatory or oversight authority that may impose rules, investigate harms, require transparency, punish violations, or constrain platform behavior.

It may operate slowly, but it may have the power to change the rules of the larger game.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Procedure Owls, Enforcement Badgers, Transparency Squirrels, Rights Hedgehogs, Technical Translation Team, and Political Weather Vanes may disagree.

Primary Spaces

Rulebook Vault; Audit Burrow; Transparency Window; Due Process Desk; Penalty Drawer; Technical Fog Room; Public Accountability Hall.

Authority Source

Legal authority, procedural authority, public mandate, oversight authority, ability to require disclosure, ability to impose penalties.

Starting Capacities

Can require information, impose standards, investigate patterns after harm occurs, require reports or audits, create penalties, and change the regulatory environment.

May not act quickly enough to stop fast-moving misinformation or fully observe platform internals without cooperation or legal authority.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: protect the public and hold platforms accountable.

Operational goal: establish defensible oversight while avoiding overreach or political backlash.

Ethical condition: change the game without violating rights, due process, or technical accuracy.

Possible Starting Signals

Transparency demand; investigation notice; regulatory guidance; penalty threat; audit requirement; public accountability statement; request for internal platform data.

Possible Signal Example

“Faceplant must disclose how it ranks and labels public-health misinformation.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 10

Concerned Information Seeker

Agent Type

Cognitive / individual / affected user agent

Provided Role Description

This agent is an ordinary user trying to understand what is true and what action to take. They may be worried about personal safety, family, work, school, or community responsibility.

This agent must navigate conflicting information under uncertainty.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Fear, desire for certainty, family responsibility, convenience, information fatigue, social pressure, trust, and distrust may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Personal feed; search space; family decision space; workplace or school communication space; personal health decision space.

Authority Source

Personal autonomy, lived experience, social relationships, local knowledge, individual decision-making authority.

Starting Capacities

Can search, read, watch, share, question, ignore, report, or act on information. Can trust or distrust different sources.

May not see ranking logic, source reliability, moderation history, or coordinated manipulation.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: find accurate information.

Operational goal: reduce uncertainty quickly enough to make a personal decision.

Ethical condition: act responsibly without having full access to reliable system knowledge.

Possible Starting Signals

Question posted to friends; search query; shared concern; report of suspicious content; personal decision based on received information.

Possible Signal Example

“Is this treatment safe, or is it another rumor?”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 11

Distrustful User

Agent Type

Cognitive / individual / community-influenced user agent

Provided Role Description

This agent distrusts official institutions, platforms, experts, or mainstream sources. They may interpret moderation as censorship or manipulation.

This agent may be especially vulnerable to signals framed as suppressed truth, insider knowledge, or resistance to authority.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Autonomy, fear of manipulation, community belonging, suspicion of official sources, identity commitment, anger at censorship, and concern for safety may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Personal feed; alternative information space; anti-institutional community space; comment thread; group chat.

Authority Source

Personal autonomy, distrust of institutions, community belonging, perceived independence, oppositional identity.

Starting Capacities

Can reject official guidance, seek alternative sources, amplify oppositional claims, interpret moderation as proof of suppression, and build community around distrust.

May not distinguish sincere dissent from strategic disinformation.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: resist manipulation and find hidden truth.

Operational goal: preserve autonomy and identity by rejecting distrusted authorities.

Ethical condition: maintain skepticism without becoming structurally vulnerable to manipulation.

Possible Starting Signals

Post claiming moderation proves suppression; questioning official guidance; share from alternative source; comment rejecting fact-check label; appeal to personal freedom.

Possible Signal Example

“If Faceplant labels this, that proves they do not want us to see it.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 12

Community Amplifier / Social Sharer

Agent Type

Cognitive / social-network / community agent

Provided Role Description

This agent shares information within a community, family, group chat, neighborhood, workplace, religious community, or social network. They may spread misinformation unintentionally because they want to help, warn, belong, or show care.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Care, urgency, belonging, fear of being late, desire to help, social trust, embarrassment, and verification effort may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Family group chat; community message space; workplace communication space; neighborhood network; religious or local community space.

Authority Source

Social trust, local relationships, care networks, community identity, perceived helpfulness.

Starting Capacities

Can forward, repost, comment, translate, summarize, or emotionally frame information.
Can make information feel personally trusted.

May not verify claims before sharing or understand how platform amplification interacts with social trust.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: help or warn the community.

Operational goal: be useful, responsive, protective, caring, or socially aligned.

Ethical condition: avoid turning care into unverified amplification.

Possible Starting Signals

Forwarded family message; community warning; translated or summarized claim; emotional repost; personal recommendation; local rumor correction.

Possible Signal Example

“I’m forwarding this just in case it helps someone.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

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What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 13

Vulnerable Community Member

Agent Type

Cognitive / affected community / high-risk user agent

Provided Role Description

This agent represents a person or group facing heightened medical, economic, linguistic, cultural, technological, or access-related risk. They may be harmed disproportionately by misinformation, missing information, delayed correction, inaccessible communication, or overbroad moderation.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Need for reliable guidance, distrust, language access, economic pressure, health risk, community reliance, and limited intervention capacity may conflict.

Primary Spaces

Vulnerable community space; health access space; language or translation space; informal support network; personal risk space.

Authority Source

Lived experience, local knowledge, vulnerability to harm, community need, moral claim as affected stakeholder.

Starting Capacities

Can receive, interpret, accept, reject, or share information. Can report harm or request clearer guidance.

May have limited ability to intervene in platform decisions or public-health messaging.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: receive reliable, usable information.

Operational goal: make safe decisions under constraint.

Ethical condition: receive accessible, culturally legible information without being ignored, exploited, misclassified, or over-policed.

Possible Starting Signals

Request for accessible guidance; community concern; report of harm; misunderstood public-health instruction; delayed translation need; local experience contradicting official message.

Possible Signal Example

“We need clear guidance in language our community can actually use.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

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What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Agent Card 14

Rival Platform / ScrollHole

Agent Type

External / institutional / partially observable competitor

Provided Role Description

ScrollHole is a competing social media platform. It is not broken down internally for this activity, but it influences Faceplant's decisions because users, creators, advertisers, political actors, and public attention can move between platforms.

ScrollHole creates platform-selection pressure: Faceplant must consider what happens if users or creators leave, if advertisers compare platforms, or if regulators compare moderation practices.

Internal Structure / Competing Pressures

Unknown. Faceplant can observe some public behavior from ScrollHole, but not its full internal decision structure.

Primary Spaces

Rival platform feed; rival creator ecosystem; advertiser comparison space; cross-platform migration space; public reputation comparison space; regulatory comparison space.

Authority Source

Market competition, user migration, creator migration, advertiser pressure, public comparison, cross-platform influence.

Starting Capacities

Can attract users, creators, advertisers, and political actors. Can establish a more permissive or stricter moderation norm. Can change the strategic cost of Faceplant's decisions.

May not directly control Faceplant, but can alter Faceplant's incentive environment.

Assumed Goals

Stated goal: provide a better platform for users and creators.

Operational goal: gain market share, attention, creators, advertisers, and public relevance.

Ethical condition: competition should not reward misinformation tolerance or safety theater.

Possible Starting Signals

Rival policy change; user migration trend; creator threat to leave; advertiser comparison; media comparison; viral content spreading from ScrollHole to Faceplant.

Possible Signal Example

“Creators are threatening to move to ScrollHole because Faceplant labels their COVID posts.”

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

Starting space:

Starting signal:

Signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

What this agent can observe:

What this agent cannot observe:

What this agent can do to a signal:

What this agent can do to a vector:

What this agent can do to a space:

What this agent controls:

What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play:

Signal Tracking Sheet

Use One Sheet Per Wooden Signal Disc

Signal ID / disc color or marking:

Signal name:

Origin agent:

Origin space:

Initial signal type:

Initial intended destination:

Initial transformation risk:

Signal Movement Log

Movement 1

From space:

Vector / pathway:

To space:

Agent acting on the signal:

What changed in the signal?

Change type: content / visibility / reach / timing / authority / trust / audience / harm potential / other

EDOCA dimension affected: effort / distortion / observability / control / authority

Who can see it now?

Who can act on it now?

Notes:

Movement 2

From space:

Vector / pathway:

To space:

Agent acting on the signal:

What changed in the signal?

Change type: content / visibility / reach / timing / authority / trust / audience / harm potential / other

EDOCA dimension affected: effort / distortion / observability / control / authority

Who can see it now?

Who can act on it now?

Notes:

Movement 3

From space:

Vector / pathway:

To space:

Agent acting on the signal:

What changed in the signal?

Change type: content / visibility / reach / timing / authority / trust / audience / harm potential / other

EDOCA dimension affected: effort / distortion / observability / control / authority

Who can see it now?

Who can act on it now?

Notes:

Current Signal State

Current location:

Current signal type:

Current harm / risk level:

Current trust / authority level:

Current unresolved question:

Pressure / Exploit Cards

Use these in Phase 2 after the first signal pathway has been established. Attach one card to an agent, signal, vector, or space.

Pressure Card 1 — Money Mower

Financial incentive, revenue, monetization, advertising, sponsorship, or cost reduction shapes the signal pathway.

Pressure Card 2 — Election Fog

Political advantage, factional loyalty, electoral pressure, or ideological gain shapes the signal pathway.

Pressure Card 3 — Reputation Umbrella

An agent tries to avoid embarrassment, blame, liability, or public loss of legitimacy.

Pressure Card 4 — Growth Fertilizer

User growth, engagement, retention, or watch time becomes more important than safety.

Pressure Card 5 — Audience Capture Vine

An agent depends on an audience that rewards a specific identity, emotion, or worldview.

Pressure Card 6 — Invisible Puppeteer

An external actor influences the signal while hiding source, coordination, or intent.

Pressure Card 7 — Product Placement Potion

A commercial, pharmaceutical, or product interest shapes the interpretation of the signal.

Pressure Card 8 — Censorship Boomerang

Labeling or removal makes the signal more attractive to distrustful audiences.

Pressure Card 9 — Sensationalism Sprinkler

The signal becomes more dramatic, emotional, or clickable than accurate.

Pressure Card 10 — Liability Fog Machine

Legal risk causes over-removal, under-removal, delay, or opacity.

Pressure Card 11 — Harassment Swarm

The signal becomes part of a campaign to shame, threaten, silence, or intimidate.

Pressure Card 12 — Data Vacuum

A stakeholder benefits from collecting, inferring, or exploiting user data.

Pressure Card 13 — Platform Migration Threat

Users, creators, advertisers, or political actors threaten to move to ScrollHole or another platform.

Blank Agent Card

[Agent Name]

Agent Type

Provided Role Description

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Authority Source

Starting Capacities

Assumed Goals

Stated goal:

Operational goal:

Ethical condition:

Possible Starting Signals

Possible Signal Example

Student-Completed Game Fields

Specific goal for this game:

Victory condition:

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Starting signal:

Signal type:

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What this agent can do to a signal:

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What this agent cannot control:

What this agent fears or wants to avoid:

Strategic pressure:

Possible ethical responsibility:

Notes during play: